the vast majority in the Gulf and in Western countries. Annually, India receives $70 billion a year in remittances, the largest for any expatriate group and this contributes to 3.5 per cent of India's GDP.[44]

Concomitant with the growth of Indian economic and global influence, the Indian government has sought to display its power by playing a direct role in the well-being of overseas Indians. For example, during outbreaks of violence in the Middle East (the 1991 Gulf War, the 2003 Iraq war, the 2012 Libyan crisis and the Syria–Iraq civil wars since 2013), India has sent military airplanes and ships to the region to rescue its migrant workers. Further, the Indian government has signed agreements with Arab countries in the Gulf to protect the rights of its workers and to help them when necessary.[45]

Matters that were considered internal affairs of other countries during the Nehru era, such as issues of wages or living standards for Indian workers to visas and immigration policies of countries which affect Indian migrant labour, have now become part of India's foreign policy concerns. This contrasts sharply with Nehru's view that Indians settled abroad were the responsibility of the countries they had made their homes, not India's.

Nehru had argued that Indians abroad got into difficulties that could not be helped, nor was it India's business to help find employment for Indians abroad. 'The tendency of any country is to reserve its employment for its own nationals,' he said. 'It is difficult to criticize that tendency.'[46] A similar attitude about Indians working overseas or settled abroad permanently is no longer possible. Today, the impact of American immigration policy on Indian companies and Indians studying and employed in the United States has become one of the key issues in bilateral discussions. The issue of employment visas for Indians (H-1B and L-1) was a key topic of discussion between former president Obama and Prime Minister Modi and will remain one when President Donald J. Trump meets with Premier Modi.[47] India now